

March

8



1910

Woman pilot

The first woman in history to receive a pilot's licence was French actor turned aviator Raymonde de Laroche. She received her licence from the Aéro-Club de France, the only organization to issue pilot licences at the time.



1010

Epic poem

The Persian poet Abul-Qâsem Ferdowsi Tusi, better known as Ferdowsi, finished writing *Shahnameh* ("Book of Kings"). With about 100,000 lines, it ranks among the world's longest epic poems written by one person.

International Women's Day

1975

The United Nations (UN) celebrated International Women's Day for the first time on this day. This now annual event celebrates achievements throughout history and highlights issues affecting girls and women.

Also on this day

1736 Nader Shah was crowned shah of Iran. He was one of the most important leaders in Iran's history.

1817 The New York Stock Exchange was formed by a group of US stockbrokers renting offices in Wall Street. It evolved into the world's largest stock exchange.

2014 Malaysia Airlines Flight 370 disappeared from radar on the way to Beijing. The most expensive search operation in aviation history followed.



Born this day

1951 Monica Helms, US transgender activist, author, and US Navy veteran. She created the Transgender Pride Flag, first flown at a Pride Parade in Phoenix, USA.